

Rescuing the body

After the German hikers made their shocking discovery, a rescue team attempted to free the body from the ice. Despite the aid of a pneumatic chisel, the body wouldn't budge. It was not until a few days later that a second rescue team was finally able to dislodge the corpse and it was sent away for a regular autopsy in Austria.

Snow and ice

The body laid buried in snow and ice, which stopped it from decomposing. Even its eyeballs were found to be intact.

Mystery man

At first people thought the corpse belonged to a missing hiker, but at the autopsy scientists made the astonishing discovery that the body was 5,300 years old!

The Ötztal Alps

The Iceman is named Ötzi after the mountain range where he was found. He died at a height of 10,530 ft (3,210 m) in the Central Eastern Alps region known as the Ötztal Alps.

